
THE LEGAL EMPIRE

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WORK PLAN AND METHODOLOGY

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Package No. : SD-1 (1799-1970) and SD-5 (2011-till date)

Project Period : 01/06/2026 to 31/05/2027

Submitted to : Strengthening Legislative Capacity and Legal

Awareness Building Project

Legislative and Parliamentary Affairs Division

Ministry of Law, Justice and Parliamentary Affairs

1. INTRODUCTION

The Legal Empire is pleased to present this Work Plan and Methodology for the Preparation of the Code of Delegated/Subordinate Legislation of Bangladesh through Identifying and Consolidating All Existing Subordinate Legislations (Rules, Regulations, By-Laws, Orders, Notifications, etc.) under Package No. SD-1 (1799-1970) and Package No. SD-5 (2011-till date).

This document outlines our proposed approach, methodology, phased work plan, Gantt chart, quality assurance framework, risk management strategy, and deliverables schedule to ensure the successful, timely, and high-quality completion of this assignment within the project period of 01 June 2026 to 31 May 2027.

The Legal Empire recognizes the critical national importance of this assignment in consolidating Bangladesh's legislative heritage and making subordinate legislation accessible, organized, and legally coherent. Our work plan is designed to address the complexity and scale of both packages simultaneously, drawing on our team's expertise in historical legal research, legislative analysis, codification, and digital data management.

2. UNDERSTANDING OF THE ASSIGNMENT

2.1 Background and Context

Bangladesh's legislative landscape encompasses a vast body of delegated and subordinate legislation — comprising rules, regulations, by-laws, orders, statutory notifications, and other instruments — enacted under the authority of parent Acts and Ordinances. These instruments span over two centuries, from the early colonial period under the East India Company through the British Crown, the pre-Partition era, the post-Partition period under Pakistan, and post-Liberation Bangladesh up to the present day.

The Strengthening Legislative Capacity and Legal Awareness Building Project, under the Legislative and Parliamentary Affairs Division, Ministry of Law, Justice and Parliamentary Affairs, Government of the People's Republic of

Bangladesh, seeks to systematically identify, compile, consolidate, and codify this body of subordinate legislation through a structured series of packages.

The Legal Empire has been assigned (subject to selection) to prepare the Code of Delegated/Subordinate Legislation for the following specific periods:

PACKAGE SD-1 : Period 1799-1970

This package covers the colonial period, beginning with the early regulatory frameworks under the East India Company (1799), through the British Crown administration (post-1858), the late colonial period, and up to and including 1970 — the year immediately preceding the Liberation War of Bangladesh. This period encompasses:

- Colonial-era regulations and instruments
- Rules and regulations under pre-Partition British India
- Post-Partition Pakistan period instruments applicable to the territory of present-day Bangladesh
- Instruments up to December 1970

Primary sources include the Bengal Gazette, the Gazette of India, the Gazette of Pakistan (Eastern Wing), and archival government records.

PACKAGE SD-5 : Period 2011-till date

This package covers the contemporary period, from 2011 to the present day. This is a high-volume period reflecting Bangladesh's dynamic regulatory environment across ministries and departments. Key challenges include ensuring comprehensiveness, currency, and the identification of amendments, repeals, and overlapping instruments. Primary sources include the Bangladesh Gazette (Official and Extraordinary editions), Ministry records, departmental registers, and official online repositories.

2.2 Key Challenges and Our Response

Challenge	Our Response
Historical archive access (SD-1)	Engagement with National Archives, Bangladesh National Museum, Law Ministry library, and digital colonial-era repositories (e.g., Indian Kanoon, Commonwealth Legal Information Institute)
Volume of instruments (SD-5)	Structured workflow with parallel research streams, dedicated IT specialist, and systematic database
Language of instruments (SD-1: English; SD-5: Bangla & English)	Team with proficiency in English and Bangla legal terminology; translation protocols for colonial instruments where required
Status determination (active/amended/repealed)	Legal analysis protocol for each instrument involving cross-reference with parent Acts and repeal/amendment tables
Overlap and duplication	Systematic deduplication process with cross-ministerial verification

3. PROPOSED METHODOLOGY

The Legal Empire proposes a structured five-phase methodology aligned with standard legislative codification best practices and the requirements of the EOI notice:

PHASE 1: INCEPTION AND PLANNING

Duration: Month 1 (June 2026)

1.1 Inception Meeting with Project Office

- Formal introduction and briefing session with the Project Director and project team
- Clarification of scope, deliverables, reporting requirements, and submission formats
- Establishment of communication protocols and points of contact

1.2 Detailed Review of Terms of Reference (ToR)

- Thorough review and internal analysis of the ToR for both packages
- Identification of specific output requirements, quality standards, and submission timelines
- Alignment of firm's work plan with ToR requirements

1.3 Preparation and Submission of Inception Report

- Compilation of a comprehensive Inception Report including:
 - * Refined work plan and Gantt chart
 - * Team mobilization and assignment schedule
 - * Data source identification and access strategy
 - * Research methodology and tools
 - * Quality assurance framework
- Submission to Project Office for review and approval

1.4 Team Mobilization

- Full mobilization of all seven (7) key professionals
- Role and responsibility briefing
- Assignment of research streams (SD-1 and SD-5) to team members
- Internal training session on project methodology and standards

1.5 Data Source Mapping

- Identification and listing of all primary and secondary data sources:
 - * Bangladesh National Archives
 - * Law Ministry Library and Records Room
 - * Bangladesh Gazette archives (print and digital)
 - * National Library of Bangladesh
 - * Dhaka University Central Library (law section)
 - * Relevant Ministries' records rooms
 - * Online repositories (for SD-1 colonial instruments)
 - * Supreme Court Library
- Establishment of access protocols and research visit schedules

KEY DELIVERABLE: Inception Report

PHASE 2: IDENTIFICATION AND COLLECTION

Duration: Months 2-4 (July-September 2026)

2.1 Systematic Identification of Subordinate Legislation

For Package SD-1 (1799-1970):

- Systematic review of the Bengal Gazette (historical), Gazette of

- India, Gazette of Pakistan, and archived government records
- Identification of all rules, regulations, by-laws, orders, and notifications enacted during 1799-1970 applicable to present-day Bangladesh
- Review of existing legislative compilations (Acts of Parliament, President's Orders, etc.) for enabling provisions that spawned subordinate instruments
- Engagement with the National Archives of Bangladesh for archival access to pre-Liberation records

For Package SD-5 (2011-till date):

- Systematic review of the Bangladesh Gazette (all editions) from 2011 to the present
- Review of official Ministry and Departmental websites and records
- Identification through the Bangladesh Legal Repository (if available) and Ministry of Law's published compilations
- Consultation with individual Ministries and Departments for confirmation and supplementary instruments

2.2 Creation of Master Inventory

- Development of a structured Master Inventory/Database for each package
- Each entry to include:
 - * Serial Number
 - * Title/Name of the Instrument
 - * Type (Rules / Regulations / By-Laws / Order / Notification / Other)
 - * Parent/Enabling Act/Ordinance
 - * Ministry/Department responsible
 - * Date of enactment/gazette notification
 - * Gazette reference (volume, number, date, page)
 - * Current status (Active / Amended / Repealed / Obsolete)
 - * Remarks
- Database to be maintained in structured spreadsheet/database format for ongoing update and final submission

2.3 Collection of Authenticated Copies

- Collection of authenticated gazette copies or certified true copies of all identified instruments
- Scanning and digitization of physical copies where required
- Organization of collected instruments by package, ministry, and chronological order

KEY DELIVERABLE: Preliminary Inventory Report (Draft) for both packages

PHASE 3: ANALYSIS AND CONSOLIDATION

Duration: Months 4-7 (September-December 2026)

3.1 Legal Analysis of Each Instrument

- Substantive review of each identified subordinate legislation
- Analysis to cover:
 - * Legal validity and vires (within the scope of enabling legislation)
 - * Current operative status (active, partially active, amended, or repealed)
 - * Date and nature of any amendments
 - * Relationship with other instruments (parent Acts, related rules)
- Annotation of status and legal observations for each instrument

3.2 Classification and Categorization

- Classification of all instruments by:
 - * Ministry / Department / Authority
 - * Subject matter / thematic category
(e.g., Administrative, Civil Service, Commerce, Land Revenue, Environment, Finance, Health, etc.)
 - * Legal type (Rules, Regulations, By-Laws, Orders, Notifications)
 - * Chronological period (within each package)
 - * Status (Active / Amended / Repealed / Obsolete)
- Development of a Classification Schema and Taxonomy for the Code

3.3 Cross-Referencing with Parent Legislation

- Systematic cross-referencing of each subordinate instrument with its parent/enabling Act or Ordinance
- Preparation of a Parent Legislation Index linking Acts with all their associated subordinate instruments

3.4 Gap and Inconsistency Analysis

- Identification of:
 - * Gaps where enabling provisions exist but subordinate instruments cannot be located
 - * Conflicts or overlaps between instruments
 - * Instruments lacking clear legal authority
 - * Obsolete instruments that have not been formally repealed
- Preparation of a Gap and Inconsistency Report for Project Office

3.5 Consolidation of Instruments

- Consolidation of all verified and classified instruments into a structured dataset for codification

KEY DELIVERABLE: (i) Consolidated Inventory with Legal Analysis,
(ii) Gap and Inconsistency Report

PHASE 4: CODIFICATION AND DRAFTING

Duration: Months 7-10 (December 2026 - March 2027)

4.1 Design of the Code Structure

- Development of the structural framework for the Code of Delegated/Subordinate Legislation for each package:
 - * Arrangement by Ministry/Department and subject matter
 - * Chapter and Part designations
 - * Numbering and referencing system
 - * Introductory notes, prefaces, and editorial conventions
 - * Index and cross-reference tables
- Submission of structure proposal to Project Office for approval before drafting commences

4.2 Preparation of the Code

- Structured compilation of all verified subordinate legislation into the approved Code format
- Each entry in the Code to include:
 - * Full title of the instrument
 - * Enabling/parent Act reference
 - * Ministry/Department
 - * Date of enactment/gazette notification
 - * Gazette reference
 - * Full text of the instrument (or authenticated excerpt where full text is voluminous)

- * Current status annotation
- * Amendment history (if applicable)
- Separate volumes/sections for SD-1 and SD-5

4.3 Indexing and Referencing

- Preparation of a comprehensive General Index
- Ministry-wise Index
- Subject-matter Index
- Parent Act / Enabling Legislation Index
- Chronological Index

4.4 Editorial Review and Internal Quality Check

- First round of internal quality review by the Quality Assurance / Review Specialist
- Checking for accuracy, completeness, consistent formatting, correct citations, and legal precision
- Correction and revision cycle

KEY DELIVERABLE: Draft Code of Delegated/Subordinate Legislation
(SD-1 and SD-5) -- First Draft

PHASE 5: FINALIZATION AND SUBMISSION

Duration: Months 10-12 (March-May 2027)

5.1 Stakeholder Review and Feedback

- Submission of First Draft Code to the Project Office for review
- Presentation of the Draft Code to the Project Director and relevant stakeholders
- Collection and systematic collation of feedback and review comments

5.2 Revision and Finalization

- Incorporation of all feedback and review comments from the Project Office and stakeholders
- Second round of internal quality assurance review
- Final editing, formatting, and proofreading of the complete Code

5.3 Preparation of Final Deliverables

- Preparation of hard copy and digital (soft copy) versions of:
 - * Final Code of Delegated/Subordinate Legislation (SD-1 and SD-5)
 - * Final Master Inventory (digital database)
 - * Gap and Inconsistency Report (final)
 - * All supporting indexes and annexures
 - * Project Completion Report

5.4 Final Submission and Handover

- Formal submission of all deliverables to the Project Office
- Handover of all digital files, databases, and raw research materials
- Final presentation to the Project Director and Ministry officials
- Signing of project completion documentation

5.5 Post-Submission Support

- Availability for clarifications and minor revisions for [X] days following final submission
- Provision of user guidance on the digital database (if required)

KEY DELIVERABLE: (i) Final Code of Delegated/Subordinate Legislation
(SD-1 and SD-5) -- Hard copy and Soft copy
(ii) Final Master Inventory Database

(iii) All Supporting Indexes and Annexures
(iv) Project Completion Report

4. GANTT CHART -- PROJECT TIMELINE (June 2026 - May 2027)

The following text-based Gantt chart illustrates the planned timeline for all activities across the 12-month project period.

LEGEND: [##] = Active [-] = Overlapping/Review [] = Inactive

Month: Jun Jul Aug Sep Oct Nov Dec Jan Feb Mar Apr May
Year: 2026 2026 2026 2026 2026 2026 2026 2026 2027 2027 2027 2027 2027

PHASE 1: INCEPTION AND PLANNING

1.1 Inception Meeting [##][] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] []
1.2 Review of ToR [##][] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] []
1.3 Inception Report [##][##] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] []
1.4 Team Mobilization [##][] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] []
1.5 Data Source Mapping [##][##] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] []

PHASE 2: IDENTIFICATION AND COLLECTION

2.1 ID of Legislation (SD-1) [] [##] [##] [##] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] []
2.1 ID of Legislation (SD-5) [] [##] [##] [##] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] []
2.2 Master Inventory Dev. [] [##] [##] [##] [-] [] [] [] [] [] [] []
2.3 Collection/Digitization [] [##] [##] [##] [-] [] [] [] [] [] [] []
Deliverable: Prelim. Inventory[] [] [] [##] [] [] [] [] [] [] []

PHASE 3: ANALYSIS AND CONSOLIDATION

3.1 Legal Analysis [] [] [] [##] [##] [##] [-] [] [] [] [] []
3.2 Classification [] [] [] [##] [##] [##] [-] [] [] [] [] []
3.3 Cross-Referencing [] [] [] [] [##] [##] [##] [] [] [] [] []
3.4 Gap & Inconsistency Anal. [] [] [] [] [##] [##] [##] [] [] [] [] []
3.5 Consolidation [] [] [] [] [] [##] [##] [] [] [] [] []
Deliverable: Consol. Inv.+GAP [] [] [] [] [] [] [##] [] [] [] []

PHASE 4: CODIFICATION AND DRAFTING

4.1 Code Structure Design [] [] [] [] [] [] [##] [##] [] [] [] []
4.2 Code Preparation (SD-1) [] [] [] [] [] [] [##] [##] [##] [] [] []
4.2 Code Preparation (SD-5) [] [] [] [] [] [] [##] [##] [##] [] [] []
4.3 Indexing & Referencing [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [##] [##] [-] [] []
4.4 Internal QA Review [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [##] [##] [] [] []
Deliverable: 1st Draft Code [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [##] [] []

PHASE 5: FINALIZATION AND SUBMISSION

5.1 Stakeholder Review [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [##] [##] []

5.2 Revision & Finalization [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [##] [##]
 5.3 Final Deliverables Prep. [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [##] [##]
 5.4 Final Submission [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [##]
 Deliverable: Final Code + Rpt [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [##]

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KEY:
 [##] = Primary activity period for this month
 [--] = Continuation/overlap/review activity
 [] = Not the primary focus for this activity in this month

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE APPROACH

The Legal Empire will apply a rigorous, multi-layered quality assurance (QA) framework throughout the assignment to ensure accuracy, completeness, consistency, and legal precision in all outputs.

5.1 QA Framework Structure

- Level 1 - Individual Researcher Review:
 Each researcher is responsible for self-review of their own research outputs before submission to the Team Leader. All entries in the Master Inventory are to be verified against primary source documents.
- Level 2 - Team Leader Review:
 The Team Leader / Lead Legal Consultant will conduct a structured review of all research outputs, legal analyses, and codification drafts before compilation. The Team Leader will resolve discrepancies and flag issues for escalation.
- Level 3 - Quality Assurance Specialist Review:
 The dedicated Quality Assurance / Review Specialist will conduct an independent, comprehensive review of:
- All entries in the Master Inventory (completeness and accuracy)
 - All legal status determinations (active, amended, repealed)
 - The Draft Code (formatting, citation accuracy, legal precision)
 - Index completeness and consistency
- This review will be conducted prior to submission of each deliverable.
- Level 4 - Peer Review:
 Where feasible and appropriate, selected complex instruments or legal analyses will be subject to peer review by a second legal professional within the team.
- Level 5 - Project Office Review:
 Submission of draft deliverables to the Project Office for their review and feedback, with structured revision and response cycle.

5.2 QA Standards

- All citations to cite full gazette reference (volume, number, date, page)
- All status determinations to be supported by documentary evidence
- Consistent formatting throughout (as per approved template)
- Zero tolerance for factual inaccuracies in legal citations
- All amendments and repeal notes to cross-reference the amending/ repealing instrument

6. RISK MANAGEMENT

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Non-availability of historical gazette archives (SD-1)	Medium	High	Early engagement with National Archives; multiple source strategy; digital repositories
Delays in Ministry responses to information requests	Medium	Medium	Formal letters via Project Office; advance scheduling
Large volume exceeding initial estimates (SD-5)	Medium	Medium	Buffer time built into Phase 2-3; scalable team
Key professional unavailability	Low	High	Succession plan; backup professional identified
Change in project scope or requirements	Low	High	Early communication with Project Office; formal change management protocol
Force majeure / unforeseen disruption	Low	High	Contingency buffer in timeline; remote work capacity

7. DELIVERABLES SCHEDULE

S/N	Deliverable	Due Date	Phase
1	Inception Report (including revised Work Plan and Gantt Chart)	End of Month 1 (June 2026)	Ph. 1
2	Preliminary Inventory Report (Draft) for both SD-1 and SD-5	End of Month 4 (Sep. 2026)	Ph. 2
3	Consolidated Inventory with Legal Analysis (SD-1 & SD-5)	End of Month 7 (Dec. 2026)	Ph. 3
4	Gap and Inconsistency Report	End of Month 7 (Dec. 2026)	Ph. 3
5	Draft Code of Delegated/Subordinate Legislation -- First Draft (SD-1 & SD-5)	End of Month 9 (Feb. 2027)	Ph. 4
6	Final Code of Delegated/Subordinate Legislation (SD-1 & SD-5) -- Hard copy and Soft copy (digital)	End of Month 12 (May 2027)	Ph. 5
7	Final Master Inventory Database (digital, structured spreadsheet/DB)	End of Month 12 (May 2027)	Ph. 5
8	All Supporting Indexes and Annexures	End of Month 12 (May 2027)	Ph. 5
9	Project Completion Report	End of Month 12 (May 2027)	Ph. 5

Authorized Signatory:

Signature : _____

Name : [Insert Name of Authorized Signatory]

Designation : [Insert Designation]

Date : 11/03/2026

Seal of the Firm:

WORK PLAN AND METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT -- END
